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Learning with Squish

Wes Scholl is a Marine veteran, platform engineer and dad in Alexandria, Virginia. He writes the Learning with Squish books, simple concept books for ages 1 to 4 starring his daughter Lilyan and Squish, a friendly purple block who can turn into any shape. The series now has 14 books.

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Wes Scholl



Wes and Lilyan

Quick facts

Series	Learning with Squish
Author and publisher	Wesley (Wes) Scholl, Konjo Publishing
Hometown	Alexandria, Virginia
Ages	1 to 4 for most books; 2 to 5 for Shapes and the Craft Book
Books	14 titles: 9 story books, 2 collections and 3 activity books
Formats	Paperback on Amazon; Kindle ebook for the story books and collections; hardback for both collections
Where to buy	Amazon (**amazon.com/dp/B0HCXGQ9VX**)
Website	**squish.run/books**
Instagram	**@learningwithsquish**
Press contact	**wesleyscholl@gmail.com**

The story behind Squish



Squish was never meant to be a children's book character. He started as a small purple mascot that Wes drew for an AI project.

His daughter Lilyan saw Squish on the screen and loved him right away. She asked to see him every day ("I want Squish book"), so Wes began making up stories about Lilyan and Squish playing together.

Wes's wife suggested a Squish book to help Lilyan with good habits. Wes printed it as a board book for Father's Day, and that book became Learning Good Habits with Squish, the first title in the series.

Today the series has 14 books, and Lilyan, the little girl on every page, is still the first reader of every draft.

Press and appearances

ABC7 Good Morning Washington, Chapter Chats, October 29, 2026. Wes talked about the series and the new Halloween book in the studio. **Watch on WJLA.com**

Books Beyond Borders read-aloud (YouTube), November 8, 2026. Melissa Briones read Learning to Trick-or-Treat with Squish aloud on her channel. **Watch on YouTube**

Local appearances. Book tables at the Runnymede Fall Festival in Alexandria and at a local daycare Halloween party on October 30, 2026.

About Wes (long bio)

Wes Scholl went through Marine Corps boot camp at Parris Island and later became a coder and then a platform engineer. He lives in Alexandria, Virginia, with his wife and their toddler daughter, Lilyan, and he also writes songs and does woodworking in his spare time.

Learning with Squish started at home. Squish was a little mascot Wes drew for an AI project. Lilyan saw him on the screen and asked to see Squish every day, so Wes started making up stories about the two of them. His wife suggested a Squish book to help with good habits, and Wes printed the first one as a Father's Day board book. It grew into a series of 14 books about habits, counting, colors, shapes, opposites, letters, weather and the holidays.

Wes writes, plans, designs, lays out and edits every book himself, and he reads every draft to Lilyan before it is published. He uses AI image tools as one part of his illustration process while directing and editing every page. On October 29, 2026, he talked about the series on ABC7's Good Morning Washington.

Interview topics

For parenting and dad audiences. How a busy dad can be present in small ways, and how a bedtime ritual with one toddler turned into a book series. Wes can talk about reading the same book for the twentieth time, and why that repetition is the point.

For veteran and military family audiences. From Parris Island to platform engineering to children's books. Wes can talk about structure, routines and good habits, and why those lessons start at age one.

For early literacy and educator audiences. Why the books are short, rhythmic and repetitive, with recap pages and a Note for Grown-Ups at the end of every book. Wes can share how Lilyan's real questions and phrases end up on the page.

For tech and AI audiences. An honest conversation about AI and creativity. Squish began as the mascot for an AI project. Wes writes, plans, designs, lays out and edits every book himself, and he uses AI image tools as one part of his illustration process. He can talk plainly about what those tools do well, what they get wrong, and where the human work goes.

For holiday segments. Learning the 12 Days of Christmas with Squish is a counting book you can sing, from one star on top of the tree to twelve bells. It works as a short on-air sing-along.

Sample questions

1. **What did Lilyan see in Squish that made her ask for him every day?**
2. **How did a Father's Day gift turn into a 14-book series?**
3. **What did the Marine Corps teach you that shows up in books about good habits?**
4. **Why are the books so short and so repetitive, and why does that work for toddlers?**
5. **How does Lilyan help make the books? What does she say when she reads a new draft?**
6. **How do you use AI tools in your illustrations, and what do you still do by hand?**
7. **What is one small reading habit any busy parent could start tonight?**
8. **Which book should a family with a one-year-old start with?**

The books

	TITLE	AGES	FORMATS	AMAZON
	**Learning Good Habits with Squish** A day of toddler routines with a repeating “Why do we...?” question.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HCX5FVPT
	**Learning to Count with Squish** Counting from 1 to 20 with fruit, plus a “Let's Count Again!” recap every five numbers.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HDMJN7XK
	**Learning Colors with Squish** 24 colors, each with a short rhyme and an animal friend.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HDVLVFW1
	**The Learning with Squish Collection** Good Habits, Counting and Colors in one book.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback, hardback	B0HDS8W7MG
	**Learning Shapes with Squish** Squish POPs into 12 shapes, with recap pages.	2 to 5	Ebook, paperback	B0HHBSH96X
	**Learning Opposites with Squish** Twelve pairs of everyday opposites, from hot and cold to day and night.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HJRLC6RK
	**Learning ABCs with Squish** Squish becomes every letter from A to Z, each with an everyday object.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HLTVNZBP
	**The Learning with Squish Shapeshifter Collection** Shapes, Opposites and ABCs in one book.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback, hardback	B0HM1YJTH6
	**The Learning with Squish Coloring Book** Big, simple pages of Squish and Lilyan for first crayons.	1 to 4	Paperback	B0HN3F1HX6
	**The Learning with Squish Activity Book** Mazes, tracing, dot-to-dot and more.	1 to 4	Paperback	B0HN3K8938
	**Learning to Trick-or-Treat with Squish** A gentle Halloween counting book: knock on doors and count friendly costumes from one to ten.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HN6KVQ1K
	**Learning Weather with Squish** Sun, wind, rain, fog, ice and snow, and what to wear for each.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HNF99Z2V
	**Learning the 12 Days of Christmas with Squish** A sing-along counting book set to the familiar song.	1 to 4	Ebook, paperback	B0HP8RYLTS
	**The Learning with Squish Craft Book** 40 cut, paste and fold activities. New in November 2026.	2 to 5	Paperback	B0HR1TLK5V

Every book stands on its own. Prices change, so please check Amazon for current prices. Links are amazon.com/dp/ followed by the code shown.

How the books are made

Wes writes, plans, designs, lays out and edits every book himself, and he uses AI image tools as one part of his illustration process while directing and editing every page. He is happy to talk about this openly in any interview.

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